PhotoMatrix

User Guide

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PhotoMatrix is a portfolio platform for photography club members. You can share your photos, discover work from fellow photographers, and organise everything by club and theme.

1. Getting Started

Registration

PhotoMatrix uses invite-only registration. You need an invite link from an administrator to create an account.

1. Open the invite link you received.
2. You will be taken to the registration page where you can create an account with an email address or a social login (Google, etc.).
3. After signing up, you will be asked to create your photographer profile — enter your name and optionally select your preferred themes.

If you already have a PhotoMatrix profile from before you had a Clerk account, choose Link existing profile and select your name from the list.

Signing In and Out

- Click Sign in in the top-right corner.
- To sign out, click your name in the top-right corner and choose Sign out from the menu on the My Photos page.

2. Installing the App on Your Phone

PhotoMatrix can be installed as an app on your phone's home screen — no App Store required.

Android (Chrome):
After visiting the site, Chrome will show an "Add to Home Screen" or "Install app" banner at the bottom of the screen. Tap it and follow the prompt.

iPhone / iPad (Safari):

1. Tap the Share button (the square with an arrow pointing up) at the bottom of the screen.
2. Scroll down and tap "Add to Home Screen".
3. Give it a name and tap Add.

Once installed, PhotoMatrix opens full screen without a browser address bar, just like a native app.

3. Home Page

The home page gives a quick overview of the platform:

- **Statistics bar** — total number of photos, clubs, photographers, and themes. Each stat is a link to the corresponding section.
- **Featured photographers** — a selection of members with their latest work.
- **Recent photos** — the most recently uploaded photos across all clubs and themes.

Use the search bar at the top to find photos, photographers, themes, or clubs in one go.

4. Gallery

The Gallery shows all photos on the platform. You can narrow down what you see using the filter bar at the top:

Filter	What it does
Club	Show only photos submitted under a specific club
Theme	Show only photos tagged with a specific theme
Photographer	Show only photos by a specific photographer

You can combine filters freely. The result count updates as you filter. Click Clear filters to reset.

5. Photo Detail

Click any photo to open its detail page. Here you can:

- **Like a photo** — click the heart icon. You can unlike it by clicking again.
- **Leave a comment** — type in the comment box and press Enter or click Post. You must be signed in to comment.
- **View photographer info** — the photographer's name links to their public profile.

6. Your Profile and Photos

Click your name in the top-right corner (or navigate to My Photos) to manage your profile and your uploaded work.

Profile

- **Name** — your display name shown across the platform.
- **Bio** — a short description about yourself and your photography.
- **Avatar** — click your profile picture to upload a new one. Accepted formats: JPG, PNG, WebP.

Click the pencil icon next to your name or bio to edit, then Save.

Club Membership

Shows which clubs you belong to. To update your memberships:

1. Click the pencil icon next to Club membership.
2. Tick or untick the clubs you belong to. For each ticked club you can optionally enter the year you joined.
3. Click Save.

Specialty Themes

Shows the themes you are most interested in or specialise in. To update:

1. Click the pencil icon next to Specialty themes.
2. Tick or untick themes.
3. Click Save.

Stats

Below your photos you can see your total Likes and Comments received across all your photos.

Reordering Photos

By default your photos are shown newest first. To set a custom order:

1. Click Reorder photos.
2. Drag photos into the order you prefer.
3. Click Save order. Click Cancel to discard changes.

7. Uploading a Photo

Click Upload photo on your My Photos page (or use the upload button in the navigation).

You can add a photo in two ways:

Upload a file

- Click the upload area and select an image file from your device (JPG, PNG, WebP, up to 10 MB).

Import from URL

- Paste a direct image URL (e.g. a link to an image hosted elsewhere). PhotoMatrix will fetch and store a copy.

Fill in the details:

Field	Required	Notes
Title	Yes	The name of the photo

Club	No	The club this photo is associated with
Theme	No	The theme this photo belongs to
Description	No	A short caption or story behind the photo

Click Upload to publish. The photo will appear in your profile and in the Gallery immediately.

8. Themes

Themes are the creative categories that photos are organised around — things like Landscapes, Street Photography, or Portraits.

Browsing Themes

Navigate to Themes in the top menu. Each theme card shows its name and how many photos have been submitted under it. Click a theme to see all photos tagged with it.

Proposing a New Theme

If you think a theme is missing, you can suggest it:

1. Go to My Photos and scroll down to Specialty themes.
2. Below your themes, enter your proposed theme name in the text field.
3. Click Propose theme.

Your proposal is sent to the administrators for review. You will receive an email when it is approved or rejected.

Tracking Your Proposals

Under My Theme Proposals on the My Photos page, you can see all proposals you have submitted and their current status:

- [Pending] Pending — waiting for an administrator to review it
- [Approved] Approved — the theme has been added to the library
- [Rejected] Rejected — the proposal was not accepted

Withdrawing a Proposal

If your proposal is still pending and you no longer want it considered, click the Withdraw link next to it. This removes it immediately.

9. Clubs

Navigate to Clubs in the top menu to see all registered photography clubs. Each club page shows:

- Club description, location, and website
- All photographers who are members
- All photos submitted under that club

10. Photographers

Navigate to Photographers in the top menu to browse all members. Click a photographer's name or avatar to view their public profile, including their club memberships, specialty themes, and all their uploaded photos.

11. Switching Language

PhotoMatrix is available in English and Dutch. Click the language indicator (EN / NL) in the top-right corner to switch. Your choice is remembered for future visits.